

File manipulation

The most fundamental advantage that any programming language offers is the process to create and manipulate with data structures. The structures that we create in PHP are sometimes difficult to memorise. Usually, these include variables, like arrays and objects or some disk units like files and database tables. In spite of these disadvantages, the frequency, ease and consistency with which a file is created, modified and erased, is more important.

File manipulation is one of the most basic requirements for professional programmers. PHP offers multiple options to create, upload and edit files. In PHP, as with many other programming languages, you can read from a file and also write into it. PHP also offers complete scope for file and directory manipulation. With PHP installed on your local drive, you can read and record directory contents, recover documents into different data styles and view and transform file features. You can also change file permissions and search for special files.

File manipulation is a distinguishing feature of PHP. While manipulating a file, you must take immense care, as even a minor mistake on your part can cause substantial damage. Some of the common errors committed by most programmers, while manipulating a file include:

- Editing a wrong file
- Filling a hard-drive with unnecessary data
- Accidentally deleting contents from a file.

8.1 Testing Files

PHP makes testing, reading and writing, simple and compact. Before you start work with a file or a directory, always collect detailed information. In PHP4, there are multiple options that help in assorting information about files on your personal computer. In this section of PHP, we will discuss some of the useful facts about files. Suppose you have saved a file assigning a name to